

Your Photography Studio

PHOTOGRAPHY — PRICE LIST

SERVICE	TIME	PRICE
Portrait session (1 hr, 20+ edits)	1 hour	\$275
Wedding — 6 hr coverage	6 hours	\$3,000
Wedding — 8 hr + second shooter	8 hours	\$4,500
Additional hour	per hour	\$500

Wedding packages include edited galleries; travel beyond 30 miles quoted separately. Ask about albums.

Made with mainstreettoolbox.com — free pricing tools for small business

The numbers behind this list

Every price on the front page is anchored to published 2026 US industry data — this page shows where each number comes from, and how wide the market band is. Where you land inside a band is your market position, your costs and your call.

Service	This list	2026 US band	Sources
Portrait session	\$275	\$150–400	Bark.com
Wedding average	\$3,000	\$2,000–5,000 typical	The Knot Real Weddings Study
8-hr package	\$4,500	\$3,500–6,000	The Knot; industry guides
Additional hour	\$500	\$400–800/hr	Industry guides

Bands are a synthesis across the named sources; individual publishers' own ranges sit above or below. Verified September 2026 · full database: mainstreettoolbox.com/benchmarks/service-pricing-2026/

How to work this list

Packages beat hourly for weddings

Clients fear open-ended bills. Quote full-day coverage as a package; keep the hourly rate as your internal math, not the headline.

The three-tier trick

Good / Better / Best. Most buyers pick the middle — build your target package as the middle option and price the others around it.

Second shooter economics

A second shooter costs you \$150–300 and prices at +\$500–800 on the package. It's the highest-margin line on the menu.

Albums and prints are where margin hides

Price delivery separately from coverage. Clients who balk at \$4,500 still add a \$600 album.

The booking fee

20–30% non-refundable booking fee secures the date. It filters tyre-kickers and pays for the hold.

Rush delivery is a price lever

Standard 6-week gallery delivery; 2-week rush = +25%. Same files, priced impatience.

Free interactive calculators for this trade: **mainstreettoolbox.com** — type your numbers, get the band.

US pricing across the map — what the data shows

National bands hide huge regional spreads. These are the published data points for this trade — use them to place your city on the map.

Market / region	What the data shows	Source
National baseline	Wedding average \$3,000 (The Knot); typical packages \$2,000–5,000; portrait sessions \$150–400	The Knot; Bark.com
Austin example	Wedding photographers \$3,000–10,000 depending on experience and coverage	Austin market guides
Metro & destination premium	NYC and destination markets price far above national averages	The Knot; industry guides

Regional points are as published by the named sources. Where your city isn't listed, the coastal/metro premium pattern is the planning heuristic — then validate locally (next page).

How to judge YOUR local market — the five-step method

1. **Start from the national band** — pages 1–2 of this kit.
2. **Apply the regional adjustment** — coastal metros +20–50% across our research; small towns slightly under. Your state's cost-of-living index is a reasonable proxy.
3. **Compute your cost floor** — (your loaded hours + materials/supplies) for the job. No quote below the floor, ever. It's the line between a business and a hobby.
4. **Validate locally** — three published local prices (Angi/HomeGuide zip-level or competitor pages) tell you where the market actually clears.
5. **Set your band and review quarterly** — booked out two weeks straight? Move up. Empty for a month? Your floor is above your market.

Worked example — 6-hour wedding, mid-size city (~500k population)

Step 1. National: avg \$3,000; package band \$2,000–5,000.

Step 2. Regional: mid-size city $\approx$ national, not coastal $\rightarrow$ target \$2,800–3,400 for 6-hr coverage.

Step 3. Cost floor: 10 hrs (shoot+edit) $\times$ \$50 + \$300 second-shooter share + \$150 gear amortization $\approx$ \$950 $\rightarrow$ healthy margin at \$3,000.

Step 4. Validate: 3 local photographers' published packages; position yours \$100 above the cheapest with a bigger gallery promise.

The Knot's \$3,000 average is a country-wide number — your city and your gallery promise place you inside it.

Strategy — the five plays that move the number

Three tiers, middle wins

Good/Better/Best wedding packages with the middle as your target. The top tier exists to make the middle look reasonable.

Charge for the promise, not the hours

Clients buy the gallery, the culling, the edit, the album design. Hours are your math; the deliverable is the price.

The booking fee filters clients

20–30% non-refundable booking fee. Real clients pay it; tyre-kickers taught you its value.

Raise after every sold-out season

When your calendar fills, next season's prices go up 10–15%. Scarcity is the market telling you to move.

Albums are a second sale

Price coverage clean, then sell albums and prints post-wedding when the emotional peak does the selling.

Free interactive calculators for this trade: **mainstreettoolbox.com** — every rule on this page, computed for your numbers.